ground level on a 24×7 basis. Easy harbouring of criminals would not have been possible. Along with safety drills, regular training with the presence of QRTs (quick response teams) and with the people on the side of the police, Delhi would/could have been kept safer!

Delhi, in fact could have become a model, perhaps a truly Gandhian model, of policing.

In all of my 35 years of policing, I had never worked for bosses, but had worked for the service, which meant for people in need. Therefore, there was now an inner rebellion as to whom was I working for? Those politicians and bureaucrats whose sole purpose was self-perpetuation? How could I serve, and how I could work for/with, individuals who were outright shams? The choice for me was clear, which was to be consistent within. I decided to set myself free to go back to serving the people.

Ironically, the same home minister who told me that the appointment of a police commissioner was not in his hands was pushed out of his job. His hypocrisy and ineffectiveness could not be hidden, sorry to say so, by his designer garments. He ultimately paid the price. The tragedy is that it was at a very heavy and irretrievable cost of precious lives lost due to terrorist attacks. Our medieval policing stood internationally exposed.